

MD-0002: Adoption of the VIDS Document Taxonomy

Field	Value
ID	MD-0002
Type	MD - Maintainer Decision
Status	Accepted
Normative?	No. Adopts a governance model; changes no dataset requirement.
Visibility	Public (standard governance)
Proposed date	2026-07-12
Accepted date	2026-07-26
Deciders	Steering Committee / maintainers (Princeton Medical Systems)
Related	GOVERNANCE.md; CONTRIBUTING.md; MD-0001

Decision

During the PR #3 governance investigation, the maintainers concluded that the project needs an explicit document taxonomy. The taxonomy - the Normative Principle, the charter/artifact model, the five artifact types (SPEC, MD, CN, SOP, REG), and their lifecycles, visibility, authority, and enforcement - is defined in **GOVERNANCE.md**. This decision adopts that model as the project's governance framework.

Two prior open questions are resolved by this adoption: the **REG** (registry) type is adopted now rather than deferred, and **MD** is scoped to *Maintainer Decision* (public standard governance), with internal company decisions out of scope. GOVERNANCE.md is the definition of record; this decision does not restate it.

Consequences

- Retro-stamp **MD-0001** and **CN-0001** with the standard header block (type, status, normative flag, visibility).
- Create **REG-DOC** - the index of all Layer 1 artifacts.
- Migrate the §3.2 traceability material (`requirements.yaml`, requirements inventory) under **REG-REQ**.
- Add a "Document Types" cross-reference from **CONTRIBUTING.md** to GOVERNANCE.md.

Remaining open question

Whether an MD needs a distinct pre-decision (RFC) form before acceptance, or whether the existing GitHub issue + spec-change label serves that role. Left for a maintainer decision; not blocking this adoption.

Self-reference note

This decision adopts the taxonomy; it does not define it. GOVERNANCE.md (a charter document) defines it. An MD is authorized by the charter, not by itself - so there is no circular dependency.

Sign-off

Maintainer	Decision	Approval date
Dr. Joan S. Muthu	Approved	2026-07-26
John Shalen R.	Approved	2026-07-26

Approval evidence: MD-0002-ApprovalEvidence-2026-07-26.pdf

Change log

Date	Change
2026-07-12	Initial draft (Proposed).
2026-07-26	Accepted following approval by Joan S. Muthu and John Shalen R.

MD-0002 is a governance-process decision. It is non-normative with respect to dataset conformance.